

Northeastern University
Department of Chemical Engineering
CHME 6390 – Professional Development & Communication Essentials
Fall Semester 2025

Instructor: Prof. Adam K. Ekenseair
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Course Details: Lectures: F usually noon - 1:00 PM, but can vary (see Canvas)
Location: Shillman Hall (RI) Room #325

Office Hours: Prof. Ekenseair
By appointment (setup via email) as needed

Website: Accessible as CHME6390 22314 Professional Development & Communication Essentials SEC 01 Fall 2025 [BOS-2-TR] via
<https://northeastern.instructure.com/courses/224918>.

Required Textbook: N/A

Prerequisites: Graduate standing

Course Description: Explores topics related to building advanced careers in chemical engineering, with a focus on strategies for academic success, communication, and networking. Students also have an opportunity to build a sense of cohort community and to learn about ongoing research projects in the Department of Chemical Engineering, professional workplace behaviors, and ethical conduct in a research environment.

Course Outcomes: On successful completion of this course, students will be able to:
1. Describe how topics of advanced study in chemical engineering relate directly to their career paths.

Brief List of Topics to be Covered: Topics vary by semester, but will commonly include:

- Navigating Graduate School
- Exploring Opportunities Available to MS Students
- Ethics in Academic and Scholarly Pursuits
- Networking & Community Building
- Mentoring & Collaboration
- Oral Communication Skills
- Faculty Research Presentations
- Student Presentations of Experiential Aspects of Degree
- Invited Presentations by Program Alumni & Co-op Employers

Grading: Class Attendance & Participation:

100%

Grading Scale:

90-100%	Pass	90% or below	Fail
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Policies: If you want to make up for any missed course work (exams, assignments, presentations, reports), you are required to submit supporting documentation.

Academic Integrity: A commitment to the principles of academic integrity is essential to the mission of Northeastern University. The promotion of independent and original scholarship ensures that students derive the most from their educational experience and their pursuit of knowledge. Academic dishonesty violates the most fundamental values of an intellectual community and undermines the achievements of the entire University.

As members of the academic community, students must become familiar with their rights and responsibilities. In each course, they are responsible for knowing the requirements and restrictions regarding research and writing, examinations of whatever kind, collaborative work, the use of study aids, the appropriateness of assistance, and other issues. Students are responsible for learning the conventions of documentation and acknowledgment of sources in their fields. Northeastern University expects students to complete all examinations, tests, papers, creative projects, and assignments of any kind according to the highest ethical standards, as set forth either explicitly or implicitly in this Code or by the direction of instructors.

Go to <https://catalog.northeastern.edu/handbook/policies-regulations/academic-integrity/> to access the full academic integrity policy.

Student Accommodations: Northeastern University and Disability Access Services (DAS) are committed to providing disability services that enable students who qualify under Section 504 of the REHABILITATION ACT and THE AMERICANS WITH DISABILITIES ACT AMENDMENTS ACT (ADAAA) to participate fully in the activities of the university. To receive accommodations through DAS, students must provide documentation of a disability that demonstrates a current substantial limitation. Accommodations are approved based on a review of the information that is submitted and reviews are done on a case-by-case basis.

For more information, visit <https://disabilityaccessservices.sites.northeastern.edu/>.

Outreach, Engagement, Belonging Northeastern University is committed to fostering a community of belonging, which is essential to the advancement of Northeastern University's mission of teaching and research. Our university is stronger as a result of the varied backgrounds, experiences, and perspectives that all members of our global community bring to the pursuit of knowledge. Embracing this pluralism is not the work of one office, department, or academic unit. It is a shared responsibility that

spans disciplines and boundaries. By harnessing the power of our differences, we will continue to light the path to bold new ideas and life-changing discoveries.

It is my intention that students from all backgrounds and perspectives will be well served by this course, and that the diverse experiences that students bring to this class will be viewed as an asset. I welcome individuals of all ages, backgrounds, beliefs, ethnicities, genders, gender identities, gender expressions, national origins, religious affiliations, sexual orientations, socioeconomic background, family education level, ability – and other visible and nonvisible differences. All members of this class are expected to contribute to a respectful, welcoming and belonging environment for every other member of the class. Your suggestions are encouraged and appreciated.

Please visit [Belonging at Northeastern](#) for more information.

Policy on Sexual and Gender-Based Harrassment and Title IX: The Northeastern University [Policy on Sexual and Gender-Based Harassment and Title IX](#) articulates how the University will respond to reported allegations of Sexual Harassment, Quid Pro Quo Harassment, Sexual Assault, Domestic Violence, Intimate Partner Violence, Dating Violence, Stalking, Gender-Based Harassment and Retaliation, and provides a consolidated statement of the rights and responsibilities under University policies and Title IX, as amended by the Violence Against Women Reauthorization Act of 2013 and the U.S. Department of Education and Office for Civil Rights' revised regulations in 2020 to the Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 (Title IX), 20 U.S.C. § 1681. The policy describes how areas within the University will coordinate the provision of interim remedies and the prompt and effective investigation of allegations of Prohibited Offenses. This policy applies to all members of the University community, including students and prospective students, employees and prospective employees, faculty, staff and volunteers in connection with university activities. It further applies to on- or off-campus behavior involving students. Please visit <http://www.northeastern.edu/ouec> for a complete list of reporting options and further information.

Recording of Classes: This course, or parts of this course, may be recorded for educational purposes. These recordings will be made available only to students enrolled in the course, instructor of record, and any teaching assistants assigned to the course.

Only students who have arranged an accommodation with the Disability Access Services (DAS) office may use mechanical or electronic transcribing, recording, or communication devices in the classroom.